

It's All Worth It

It's a lot of work and money, but most parents and students I know feel that a college degree is well worth the effort. According to the National Center for Education Statistics, young adults between the ages of 25 and 34 with a bachelor's degree had average earnings of more than twice as much as those who didn't have a high school diploma (\$48,500 vs. \$23,900) and 62 percent more than those who completed high school (\$48,500 vs. \$30,000).¹ In addition, students often find that attending college helps them learn important critical thinking and life-management skills that are just as important as what they take away from classroom instruction. Parents can feel comfortable knowing that their son or daughter has the information and skills necessary to make wise choices in life.

I encourage you to spend some time discussing the financial aid process with your high school student and talking about all the aspects of attending college, including the financial components. You might be surprised at the insights your child has, and it's entirely possible that you may learn from each other.

Keep calm, and don't let fear get the best of you. Millions of people have been through this process and survived! Knowledge and information are your friends. That's why you've turned to me. I'm going to help you take one step at a time, and keep asking questions until you have the answers you need to make the choices that are best for you.

I also invite you to visit my website—CollegeFinancialAidAdvisors.com—join our mailing list, and keep in touch with me there. As financial aid programs and policies change, I'll continue to bring you the latest information to make the process less confusing.